

Psalms 28

My Strength and My Shield

Unto thee will I cry, O Lord my rock

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 • THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Unto thee will I cry, O LORD my rock; be not silent to me: lest, if thou be silent to me, I become like them that go down into the pit.*
- 2 *Hear the voice of my supplications, when I cry unto thee, when I lift up my hands toward thy holy oracle.*
- 3 *Draw me not away with the wicked, and with the workers of iniquity, which speak peace to their neighbours, but mischief is in their hearts.*
- 4 *Give them according to their deeds, and according to the wickedness of their endeavours: give them after the work of their hands; render to them their desert.*
- 5 *Because they regard not the works of the LORD, nor the operation of his hands, he shall destroy them, and not build them up.*
- 6 *Blessed be the LORD, because he hath heard the voice of my supplications.*
- 7 *The LORD is my strength and my shield; my heart trusted in him, and I am helped: therefore my heart greatly rejoiceth; and with my song will I praise him.*
- 8 *The LORD is their strength, and he is the saving strength of his anointed.*
- 9 *Save thy people, and bless thine inheritance: feed them also, and lift them up for ever.*

2 • CONTEXT

Psalms 28 is a personal plea for help distinguished carefully from the fate deserved by the wicked, moving from urgent cry, through imprecation against evildoers, to joyful assurance of answered prayer and a closing intercession for God's people. Henry highlights the psalm's clear moral logic: David does not ask to be spared judgment in general but specifically not to be swept away "with the workers of iniquity," trusting God to repay each according to actual deeds.

3 • VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

An urgent cry not to be treated like the silent dead if God does not hear; hands lifted toward the holy oracle in supplication—desperate but directed prayer.

Verse 3-5

A plea to be spared the fate of the wicked, who speak peace to neighbors while harboring mischief; a request that God repay them according to their deeds and the wickedness of their endeavors, since they regard not His works.

Verse 6-9

Assurance and praise: "Blessed be the Lord, because he hath heard the voice of my supplications." The Lord is David's strength and shield in whom his heart trusted, and the psalm closes with intercession for God's people—"save thy people... and lift them up for ever."

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Honest prayer distinguishes between the psalmist's own need for mercy and the deserved judgment of persistent evildoers, and answered personal prayer naturally overflows into intercession for the wider community of God's people.

Application for life today.

Bring specific, urgent requests to God rather than vague spiritual language, following David's directness ("lift up my hands toward thy holy oracle"). Ask God to help you distinguish your own need for mercy from any temptation to excuse persistent, unrepentant wrongdoing around you. And let personal answered prayer move you, as it moves David, toward interceding for others rather than stopping at gratitude for yourself.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What specific, concrete request do you need to bring to God today rather than a vague prayer?

2. Where do you need to trust God to “render to them according to their deeds” instead of taking judgment into your own hands?

3. Who could you intercede for this week, following David’s shift from personal plea to praying for God’s people?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).